

## **CERTIFIED TECHNICAL ARCHITECT PROGRAM**

### **Sovereign Bank Case Study**

### **WEEK 4**

#### **Agile Frameworks, Technical Governance, and Release and Instance Strategy**

##### **Recap:**

Last week you helped create reference architecture for Sovereign Bank and presented a roadmap for their future architecture.

##### **Objective:**

Guide Sovereign Bank to create technical governance policy for their release and instance strategy that accelerates IT delivery more efficiently, and strategically meets the needs of the bank.

Determine which agile framework to use when implementing phase one of ITSM, ITOM, CSM, and HR, while staying nimble and standing up multiple implementations of ServiceNow.

Your audience will be Albert Wan (Program Director/Platform Owner).

##### **Desired business outcomes:**

- Develop and deliver a technical governance policy for environment management and application development management.
- Leverage a strong release and instance strategy and ease of upgrade (ServiceNow release + 8 weeks).
- Implement a scalable and sustainable known agile framework for the release strategy.

##### **Key factors to consider:**

- Sovereign Bank operates in a siloed manner, and often senior management are not all on the same page when it comes to decision making, which creates significant roadblocks.

- Without established and agreed-upon governance, there are calls from the business for IT to adjust the platform, instead of adjusting business processes, which is a leading practice.
- The bank does not want to do a "big bang" release. They don't have the capacity. They are looking for guidance on an incremental release strategy.
- Going forward, additional capabilities might be identified, like Legal Service Delivery, or a Financial Services Operations implementation, which could add additional demand on the ServiceNow platform.
- Sovereign Bank has been delivering the development and operations of the ServiceNow platform with scrum teams. For each capability, a separate scrum team was created.

### Discuss with your small group:

- How can you prepare and support the platform owner in making the case for the establishment of robust technical governance to both IT senior leaders and those in the business?
- What would you recommend for the technical governance board's goals and objectives?
- What would you advise for the technical governance board's order of priorities?
- What obstacles or points of resistance do you anticipate and how would you overcome them?
- What would you advise the bank to do to avoid a burning platform (no longer able to be upgraded, changed, or extended; no longer performing)?
- Considering the bank's size and number of implementations, what are the key aspects to consider in determining the most appropriate agile framework?

### Recommendation needed:

Prepare a **10-minute** presentation:

- Recommend the governance process(es) to be put in place to drive effective decision making for the program director (related to ways to work, ceremonies required, etc.) and the platform owner (governance structure, instance strategy, etc.).
- Recommend the essential roles for the technical governance protocol to be sustainable.
- Advise the bank on their release and instance strategies to leverage ServiceNow's leading practices.
- Recommend the bank's desired implementations agile framework.